RAG Configuration

Retrieval Method

vector

Embedding Model

all-mpnet-base-v2

Chunking Strategy

section_based

Prompt Strategy

structured

Top-K Retrieval

5

Gold Standard File

rag_benchmark_answers.json

Defaults = best config from evaluation:
Vector + mpnet + section_based (MRR 1.0)
Structured prompt (ROUGE-L 0.25)

LLM: Qwen/Qwen2.5-0.5B-Instruct

Generation: temp=0.3, top_p=0.9

Mediterranean Cuisine RAG System

Single Query | Benchmark | Evaluation | Exploration Results

Run Benchmark Queries

Run all 15 benchmark queries and view results side by side.

Run All 15 Queries

Completed 15 queries!

Q0: What are the main ingredients of hummus and where did the dish originate?

Answer: The main ingredients of hummus are chickpeas and tahini. The dish originated in the Middle East, specifically in the Levant, where it was originally created.

Retrieval: 0.07s | Generation: 4.25s

[1] wikipedia_hummus_000 (score: 0.7444)

[2] wikipedia_hummus_001 (score: 0.7149)

[3] wikibooks_cookbook__hummus_000 (score: 0.6466)

[4] wikipedia_hummus_002 (score: 0.6415)

[5] wikibooks_cookbook__hummus_greek_000 (score: 0.6205)

Q1: What is falafel made from and what is its country of origin?

Answer: Falafel is made from ground fava beans, chickpeas, or both, and is generally considered to originate from Egypt.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 3.66s

[1] wikipedia_falafel_000 (score: 0.7015)

[2] wikipedia_falafel_002 (score: 0.6549)

[3] wikipedia_falafel_001 (score: 0.6416)

[4] wikipedia_ful_medames_001 (score: 0.5872)

[5] wikibooks_cookbook__falafel_000 (score: 0.5708)

Q2: How is couscous traditionally made and which countries consider it a staple food?

Answer: Traditional couscous is made from semolina wheat, rolled by hand into small, uniform pellets. It is typically served with a stew spooned on top. Countries that consider couscous a staple food include Algeria, Tunisia, Mauritania, Morocco, Libya, and Sudan.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 5.42s

[1] wikipedia_couscous_003 (score: 0.7546)

[2] wikipedia_couscous_002 (score: 0.7512)

[3] wikipedia_couscous_001 (score: 0.7455)

[4] wikibooks_cookbook__couscous_000 (score: 0.7248)

[5] wikipedia_couscous_000 (score: 0.7078)

Q3: What is a tagine and how is it traditionally cooked?

Answer: A tagine is a type of slow-cooking pot used to cook meat, poultry, or fish with vegetables and herbs. Traditionally, it originated in the Maghreb region of North Africa, including Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia, Libya, and Egypt. Here's how it is traditionally cooked:

1. **Preparation**: The first step involves preparing a simple ragout, combining meat with onions and spices like baharat or coriander.
2. **Stir-fry**: Add a starch such as cannellini beans, chickpeas, breadcrumbs, or cubed potatoes to thicken the juices. Cook until the meat becomes tender.
3. **Seasoning**: Season the stew with cheese and eggs.
4. **Bake**: Place the stew in a deep pie dish, covered with a flat earthenware pan, and bake on the stove or in the oven until the top and bottom are crispy and the eggs are fully set.
5. **Serve**: Serve the tagine topped with wedges of lemon and garnished with additional herbs if desired.

This method allows for careful control over the cooking process, preserving moisture and flavor, especially when dealing with water scarcity in the region.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 13.8s

[1] wikipedia_tagine_002 (score: 0.7503)

[2] wikipedia_tagine_001 (score: 0.7425)

[3] wikipedia_tagine_000 (score: 0.7130)

[4] blog_blog__north_africa_001 (score: 0.6353)

[5] blog_category__north_africa_001 (score: 0.6341)

Q4: What are the three core elements traditionally associated with Mediterranean cuisine?

Answer: The three core elements traditionally associated with Mediterranean cuisine are olive oil, wheat, and the grape, yielding olive oil, bread, and wine respectively.

Retrieval: 0.03s | Generation: 4.41s

[1] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_001 (score: 0.7342)

[2] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_000 (score: 0.7222)

[3] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_004 (score: 0.7012)

[4] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_003 (score: 0.6337)

[5] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_007 (score: 0.6241)

Q5: What is baklava and what are its main ingredients?

Answer: Baklava is a layered pastry dessert made of filo pastry filled with chopped nuts and sweetened with either syrup or honey. Main ingredients include:

1. Filo pastry
2. Chopped nuts (usually walnuts or pistachios)
3. Sugar
4. Honey
5. Lemon juice
6. Water
7. Rosewater
8. Orange blossom water

Some variations include:

- Lauzinaj (small pieces of almond paste wrapped in very thin pastry)
- Pakhlava (Turkish baklava)

- Bălcăvar (Romanian baklava)

Other ingredients can vary slightly between cultures and regions, but these are the essential components of modern baklava.

Retrieval: 0.03s | Generation: 10.21s

[1] wikipedia_baklava_003 (score: 0.7142)

[2] wikipedia_baklava_004 (score: 0.7099)

[3] wikipedia_baklava_002 (score: 0.6927)

[4] wikipedia_baklava_000 (score: 0.6838)

[5] wikipedia_baklava_005 (score: 0.6817)

Q6: What is tabbouleh and what are its key ingredients?

Answer: Tabbouleh is a traditional Greek salad consisting of finely chopped parsley, soaked bulgur, tomatoes, mint, and onion. Its key ingredients include:

- Parsley
- Bulgur
- Tomatoes
- Mint
- Onion

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 3.14s

[1] wikipedia_tabbouleh_000 (score: 0.6877)

[2] wikibooks_cookbook__tabbouleh_000 (score: 0.6508)

[3] wikibooks_cookbook__tabbouleh_iii_000 (score: 0.6373)

[4] wikibooks_cookbook__tabbouleh_i_000 (score: 0.6292)

[5] wikibooks_cookbook__tabbouleh_ii_000 (score: 0.6173)

Q7: What is paella and where does it originate?

Answer: Paella is a traditional Spanish dish originating from the Valencian Community in southern Spain. It originated in the mid-19th century, specifically in the Albufera lagoon near Valencia. The dish is characterized by its deep-fried rice dish, typically consisting of white rice topped with various meats, vegetables, and herbs.

Retrieval: 0.05s | Generation: 5.65s

[1] wikipedia_paella_000 (score: 0.7334)

[2] wikipedia_paella_001 (score: 0.7215)

[3] wikipedia_paella_003 (score: 0.6626)

[4] wikibooks_cookbook__paella_000 (score: 0.6606)

[5] blog_blog__spanish_cuisine_003 (score: 0.6604)

Q8: How does the preparation and use of couscous differ between Tunisia and Egypt?

Answer: The preparation and use of couscous differ significantly between Tunisia and Egypt:

For Tunisia:

- Traditional method: Uses semolina wheat rolled by hand into small, uniform pellets.
- Preparation: Steam-cooked in a steamer inserted into a pot containing melted butter and hot water.
- Serving: Often served with vegetables, meat, or fish.
- Varieties: Includes berkoukes (larger variety) and ultra-fine versions.

For Egypt:

- Modern method: Instant preparation using a microwave oven.
- Preparation: Steams in a traditional two-tiered pot with melted butter and hot water.

- Serving: Typically served for breakfast, as a light evening meal, or as a dessert.
- Varieties: Includes kasr (small pearl millet) and other cereal varieties.
- Usage: Used in French and European cuisine, particularly in Algeria and Libya.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 11.17s

[1] wikipedia_tunisian_cuisine_002 (score: 0.7374)

[2] wikipedia_couscous_003 (score: 0.7118)

[3] wikipedia_couscous_002 (score: 0.6927)

[4] wikibooks_cookbook__couscous_000 (score: 0.6840)

[5] wikipedia_couscous_000 (score: 0.6601)

Q9: Why is falafel's identification as an Israeli national dish considered controversial?

Answer: Falcel's identification as an Israeli national dish is considered controversial because it has led to accusations of cultural appropriation and gastronationalism. Critics argue that adopting the chickpea version of falafel into Israeli cuisine undermines traditional Israeli culinary traditions and practices. Additionally, the widespread acceptance of falafel as a street food in Israel suggests a lack of awareness or understanding of its significance within the country's diverse culinary landscape.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 6.22s

[1] wikipedia_israeli_cuisine_020 (score: 0.8432)

[2] wikipedia_falafel_000 (score: 0.6916)

[3] wikipedia_falafel_001 (score: 0.6902)

[4] wikipedia_israeli_cuisine_016 (score: 0.6762)

[5] wikipedia_falafel_002 (score: 0.6728)

Q10: What is the cultural significance of couscous being added to UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list?

Answer: Couscous is considered one of the most significant and integral components of North African culinary traditions. Its inclusion on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list underscores its importance both culturally and historically. As a staple food in many Maghrebian cuisines, particularly those originating from Algeria, Tunisia, and Libya, couscous holds deep historical and social significance. Its versatility allows it to be enjoyed in various settings—from formal dinners to casual gatherings—making it accessible to a broader audience. Additionally, its unique flavor profile and rich history contribute to its cultural richness, reflecting the diverse linguistic and ethnic backgrounds that contributed to its development. The addition of couscous to UNESCO's list reflects the global appreciation and respect for these traditional foods, recognizing their enduring appeal and cultural heritage.

Retrieval: 0.04s | Generation: 10.45s

[1] wikipedia_couscous_002 (score: 0.6518)

[2] wikipedia_couscous_000 (score: 0.5928)

[3] wikipedia_tunisian_cuisine_002 (score: 0.5890)

[4] wikipedia_couscous_001 (score: 0.5805)

[5] wikipedia_couscous_003 (score: 0.5405)

Q11: What distinguishes Moroccan tagine from Tunisian tagine?

Answer: Moroccan tagine is typically larger and uses a deeper pot, whereas Tunisian tagine is smaller and uses a shallower pot. This distinction affects the

amount of liquid added during preparation and baking, allowing for variations in texture and flavor.

Retrieval: 0.05s | Generation: 5.41s

[1] wikipedia_tagine_002 (score: 0.7134)

[2] wikipedia_tagine_000 (score: 0.6125)

[3] wikipedia_tunisian_cuisine_000 (score: 0.6059)

[4] wikipedia_tunisian_cuisine_001 (score: 0.6026)

[5] wikipedia_moroccan_cuisine_000 (score: 0.5854)

Q12: What are the key characteristics of Greek cuisine?

Answer: Key characteristics of Greek cuisine include:

1. **Wheat**: Wheat is the primary ingredient in Greek cuisine.
2. **Olive Oil**: Olive oil forms the backbone of Greek cuisine, used extensively in dishes like moussaka.
3. **Vegetables**: Various vegetables are commonly included in Greek cuisine, including tomatoes, aubergine (eggplant), potatoes, green beans, okra, and greens.
4. **Meat**: While less prevalent compared to Western cuisines, meats like lamb, poultry, rabbits, and pork are significant components.
5. **Herbs and Herbs**: Essential herbs like parsley, thyme, fennel seed, and bay laurel leave are prominently featured.
6. **Sweet Flavors**: Sweetness is a hallmark of Greek cuisine, evident in dishes like sweet pasties and sweet wines.
7. **Culinary Traditions**: Greek cuisine reflects local customs and cultural influences, blending elements from ancient Greece and the broader Mediterranean region.
8. **Regional Varieties**: Different regions within Greece offer unique flavors and specialties,

reflecting the varied climates and geographical features across the country.

These factors contribute to the distinct character of Greek cuisine, making it a vibrant and flavorful culinary expression of Greek heritage.

Retrieval: 0.05s | Generation: 14.31s

[1] wikipedia_greek_cuisine_000 (score: 0.7177)

[2] wikipedia_greek_cuisine_001 (score: 0.6909)

[3] wikipedia_greek_cuisine_002 (score: 0.6904)

[4] wikipedia_mediterranean_cuisine_006 (score: 0.6420)

[5] blog_blog__greece_004 (score: 0.6031)

Q13: What is the history and origin of baklava?

Answer: Baklava originated in the Byzantine Empire and became popular in the Islamic world, particularly in the region of Mesopotamia. It gained prominence in the late 19th century, becoming a staple dessert in Arab and Syrian cuisines. Today, baklava can be found in various regions across the globe, including Azerbaijan, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Georgia, Iran, Kazakhstan, Lebanon, Morocco, Russia, Serbia, Turkey, Uzbekistan, and Vietnam.

Retrieval: 0.05s | Generation: 7.96s

[1] wikipedia_baklava_000 (score: 0.8230)

[2] wikipedia_baklava_001 (score: 0.7631)

[3] wikipedia_baklava_002 (score: 0.7423)

[4] wikipedia_baklava_003 (score: 0.7087)

[5] wikipedia_baklava_004 (score: 0.6687)

Q14: What ownership dispute exists over hummus between Lebanon and Israel?

Answer: Lebanon and Israel have disputed ownership of hummus. According to the Wikipedia article, "Israel's critics describe as an appropriation of Lebanese, Palestinian or Arab culture," while proponents argue it reflects its "huge popularity and significance among the entire Israeli population, which Israel's critics describe as an appropriation of Lebanese, Palestinian or Arab culture."

Retrieval: 0.03s | Generation: 5.83s

[1] wikipedia_hummus_002 (score: 0.6536)

[2] wikipedia_hummus_001 (score: 0.5917)

[3] wikipedia_israeli_cuisine_020 (score: 0.5810)

[4] wikipedia_israeli_cuisine_006 (score: 0.5422)

[5] wikipedia_palestinian_cuisine_000 (score: 0.5400)